# OUTREACH EVENT ROADMAP

The five-step plan from picking an event to logging its impact, with a checklist and timeline for each step.

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Running your first outreach event can feel like a lot. It's really five steps, and you don't have to do them alone. This roadmap is the same plan our mentors walk teams through. Use it with or without a Spark Gears kit.

## THE FIVE STEPS

### 01 PICK YOUR EVENT

**6 TO 8 WEEKS OUT**

- [ ] Choose a format from the table below. For a first event, a library station or school demo is the easiest to pull off.
- [ ] Find a host: your public library, a teacher at a nearby elementary or middle school, a community center, or a scout troop. Ask early. Libraries plan their calendars months ahead.
- [ ] Agree on a date, a time, a room, and roughly how many kids to expect.

### 02 PLAN IT WITH A MENTOR

**4 TO 6 WEEKS OUT**

- [ ] Request support at sparkgearsinitiative.org/for-teams.html. A Spark Gears mentor is assigned to your team.
- [ ] Meet with your mentor to pick activities, set a timeline, and divide jobs on your team.
- [ ] Make a flyer and send it to your host to share. Post it on your team's social media.
- [ ] Fill out the run-of-show template so everyone knows their job on event day.

## 03 GET THE KIT

2 TO 3 WEEKS OUT

- [ ] Request a supply kit. Rookie teams and Title I schools get priority.
- [ ] Open it the day it arrives and check everything against the list. Test every electronic part.
- [ ] Print activity sheets, sign-in sheets, and the volunteer hour log.
- [ ] Do a full practice run with your team. Time each activity.

## 04 RUN IT

EVENT DAY

- [ ] Arrive at least an hour early to set up stations and test robots.
- [ ] Your mentor is on call the whole time, and in person when we can reach you in the DC, Maryland, and Virginia area.
- [ ] Assign one person to take photos (with permission) and one to count attendance.
- [ ] Have every volunteer sign in and out on the hour log.

## 05 LOG THE IMPACT

WITHIN A WEEK

- [ ] Send the signed hour log to us and we'll verify volunteer hours.
- [ ] Write down the numbers while they're fresh: attendees, ages, volunteers, hours, sign-ups.
- [ ] Thank your host. Ask if you can come back next season.
- [ ] Add the event to your engineering portfolio with a photo and two or three sentences.

## PICK A FORMAT

| FORMAT | LENGTH | AUDIENCE | GOOD FIRST EVENT? |
|---|---|---|---|
| Library STEM station | 2 to 4 hours | Drop-in, all ages, families | Yes. Low pressure and flexible |
| School robotics demo | About 1 hour | A classroom or assembly | Yes. Short and easy to schedule |
| Arduino workshop | 1 to 3 sessions | Grades 5 to 8, in pairs | Yes, with our lesson plans |
| Intro robotics camp | 5 days | Grades 6 to 9, mini teams | Better for a second or third event |

## WHAT TO RECORD FOR YOUR PORTFOLIO

| NUMBER | HOW TO GET IT |
|---|---|
| Attendees | Sign-in sheet or a tally counter at the door |
| Age range | Ask the host, or add a grade column to the sign-in sheet |
| Volunteers and hours | The volunteer hour log |
| Follow-ups | Kids or parents who asked about joining a team or a camp |
| Photos | Wide shots of the room and close-ups of hands on robots. Get permission for faces. |

**QUESTIONS? TALK TO A HUMAN.**

Email sparkgearsinitiative@gmail.com or call 571-429-9220. Request a mentor and a supply kit at sparkgearsinitiative.org/for-teams.html. We usually reply within two school days.